active agent of vertical cooperation agreements.[9]

It is important to note that the international expansion of these groups takes place in parallel to and in relation to the extension of their domestic power and areas of activity. Thus, it is precisely during the Lula government that these companies extended their overseas operations and obtained important concessions as well as capital injections and contracts for public works in Brazilian territory. Projects such as the World Cup stadiums, the Olympic Games' installations, the huge hydroelectric plants in Madeira and Belo Monte, the large-scale urban interventions in the principal Brazilian cities and the military projects in this period did not occur to the detriment of these companies' overseas activities. On the contrary, they extended their economic and political power in the domestic environment and in foreign markets simultaneously, guaranteeing them renewed central influence in the direction of the Brazilian polity. The domination of international monopoly capital seems to be altered by the prevalence of these huge private conglomerates that guide domestic policy and, at the same time, the country's international agenda.[10]

Notes

1. This chapter is the fruit of research that had the financial support of Faperi and CNPq.
2. The heavy construction industry is the economic sector that covers firms, commonly known as contractors, engaged in infrastructure works. These companies are responsible for building works preferably contracted by the state apparatus: besides ports and airports, roads, railways, waterways, bridges and viaducts in the transport sector; hydroelectric plants, thermal plants, transmission lines, substations, among others in the energy sector; sanitation works such as water and sewage treatment plants, canalisation, underwater pipelines; urbanisation projects such as public roads, pavements, public parks and others; industrial works including factories, petroleum platforms, etc.; pipelines such as oil and gas pipelines, slurry pipelines and ethanol pipelines. Often, these firms also operate in other engineering branches, executing industrial, electrical and building projects .
3. The websites of Odebrecht, Andrade Gutierrez, Camargo Corrêa, Mendes Júnior, Queiroz Galvão and OAS.
4. *O Globo*, *Folha de S. Paulo*, *O Estado de S. Paulo*, *Valor Econômico* and *Le Monde Diplomatique Brasil*.
5. For the domestic context during the dictatorship, see my forthcoming book *Estranhas catedrais: as empreiteiras brasileiras e a ditadura civil-militar, 1964–1988*.
6. Especially the explanations based on Ruy Mauro Marini's studies. See, principally, his book *Subdesenvolvimento e revolução*.
7. Thus, in *O Empreiteiro*'s 2010 list of major Brazilian contractors, Odebrecht is in first place followed by Camargo Corrêa, Andrade Gutierrez and Queiroz Galvão, precisely four of the major multinational Brazilian civil engineering firms. Mendes Júnior, which went through the bankruptcy process in the 1990s, figures in tenth place.
8. According to what we originally indicated in Campos 2013.
9. See, for example, Ana Garcia's doctoral dissertation.
10. Such as Virginia Fontes pointed out in *O Brasil e o capital-imperialismo.*